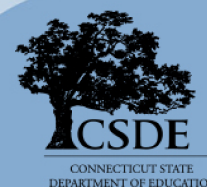


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020-21



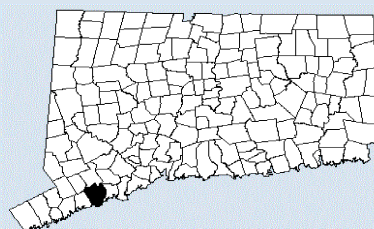
Fairfield School District

Mr. Robert Cummings, Superintendent • 203-255-8371 • <http://fairfieldschools.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	20
Enrollment	9,444
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,596
Total Expenditures ¹	\$190,942,822

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	4,832	51.2	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	575	6.1	5.2
Black or African American	247	2.6	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,127	11.9	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	459	4.9	4.0
White	7,030	74.4	49.9
English Learners	229	2.4	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,489	15.8	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	1,438	15.2	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	16	0.3
Male	847	17.9	38	0.8
Black or African American	71	28.4	10	3.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	305	27.8	11	0.9
White	1,022	14.8	23	0.3
English Learners	80	34.8	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	463	34.2	31	1.9
Students with Disabilities	420	28.3	30	1.7
District	1,532	16.5	54	0.6
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 109

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Fairfield School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	684.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	40.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	126.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	208.1
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	14.0
School Level	52.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	18.2
Support Staff	16.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	76.9
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	72.7
School Nurses	22.6
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	430.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	4	0.4	1.3
Black or African American	6	0.6	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	18	1.7	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	0.1	0.1
Two or More Races	10	1.0	0.1
White	1,016	96.3	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.8	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	18	90.0	15	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	95	95.0	79	98.8
White	525	97.2	588	96.4
English Learners	7	*	9	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	106	93.8	117	95.9
Students with Disabilities	88	84.6	117	83.0
District	707	96.3	748	96.5
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	81	56.6
Emotional Disturbance	35	39.3
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	366	85.7
Other Health Impairment	277	82.0
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	216	90.8
District	990	76.2
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Fairfield School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	150	1.6	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	89	0.9	1.1
Intellectual Disability	23	0.2	0.5
Learning Disability	427	4.6	5.8
Other Health Impairment	340	3.6	3.3
Other Disabilities	87	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	245	2.6	1.9
All Disabilities	1,361	14.5	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	26	1.9	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	57	4.2	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$118,020,770	\$12,112	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$14,548,046	\$1,512	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$9,456,676	\$983	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$513,330	\$53	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$12,488,810	\$1,298	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$7,210,487	\$749	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$17,311,051	\$1,799	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$8,990,734	\$1,304	\$1,159
Food services	\$9,472	\$1	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$2,393,446	\$249	\$151
Total	\$190,942,822	\$19,596	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$14,924,736	27.5	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,187,876	5.9	11.1
Other Salaries	\$8,418,234	15.5	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$8,983,193	16.5	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$6,375,631	11.7	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$8,847,628	16.3	22.5
Supplies	\$155,438	0.3	0.5
Property Services	\$60,538	0.1	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$3,313,117	6.1	7.2
Equipment	\$55,273	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$188	0.0	0.1
Total	\$54,321,852	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		28.4	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	95.3
State	3.0
Federal	1.4
Tuition & Other	0.3

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Fairfield School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Fairfield School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	19	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	86	96.5
English Learners	12	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	168	89.3
Students with Disabilities	122	76.2
District	750	95.5
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	96.2	459	62.0
Male	92.8	458	59.6
Black or African American	91.9	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	94.4	69	38.3
White	94.3	750	65.2
English Learners	80.0	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	90.2	63	26.8
Students with Disabilities	76.7	30	12.2
District	94.5	917	60.8
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	87.5	94.4
Male	*	90.5
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	69.0	81.9
White	85.1	94.1
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	71.0	82.1
Students with Disabilities	64.6	79.2
District	82.7	92.6
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Fairfield School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	16.5%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	28.8%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	96.4%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	60.8%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		96.4%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		95.5%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		95.9%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		82.7%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		45.2%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	95.9%	-1.9%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Fairfield School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Fairfield Board of Education approved a five-year District Improvement Plan in July 2015. This Plan outlines core strategies, specific actions and student achievement measures to guide the continuous improvement of Fairfield Public Schools through 2021. The Core Strategies are: Instructional Program, Teams and School Improvement Plans, Leadership Capacity, and Resources. Within each, specific actions are identified to have the greatest chance of impacting the Instructional Core, and therefore, student learning. Underlying the Plan is the expectation that all staff members, teams, departments, and schools engage regularly in the reflective practices of examining data, taking action, reviewing results, adjusting our practice, and evaluating effectiveness in a cycle of continuous improvement. We review focus areas and structures of the plan each year to measure progress and build on successes.

As a part of our plan to return to full time instruction for the 2020-2021 school year due to the COVID-19 pandemic, parent feedback was solicited on our reopening plan via surveys and online comment. This plan evolved based on changes in local health data and Department of Public Health guidelines. Level-based webinars were held for elementary, middle and high school parents to provide information on mitigation strategies including cohorts, social distancing and hand hygiene, as well as the transition from remote to hybrid to full in-person learning.

The staff in each of our 18 schools develop their own individual School Improvement Plans aligned to the District Improvement Plan which include school specific actions to support a positive school climate and promote growth in student learning. Each school focuses on improving classroom instruction, interventions, and social/emotional supports as students transition back to full in-person learning, a major focus this year. The school improvement teams develop and monitor instructional and communication strategies and goals to support the continuous improvement cycle. All schools host parent events to address pertinent issues such as: transitions from elementary to middle then high school; curriculum topics, such as addressing the needs of emerging readers or how to support math learning at home; supporting students dealing with stress and anxiety; school climate issues; and the college application process including financial aid. Our high schools and middle schools provide family outreach and support to students with absentee issues. Support staff helps engage students in the many activities offered during and after school. Our schools have a process for welcoming new families and also publish monthly newsletters highlighting activities and events. All our schools have active PTAs and parents are actively involved as classroom volunteers, reading buddies, School Climate Committee members, fundraisers to support classroom technology, workers to support our many school gardens, and as members of our curriculum and textbook approval committees. Several of our schools house Before and After School Childcare, some of which are also supported by our PTA groups. Our student management system and our district and school websites promote continuous and effective communication between our parents, students, staff, and the community.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Fairfield Public Schools participates in the Open Choice Program with Bridgeport Public Schools. Approximately 75 students from Bridgeport attend our schools from kindergarten through grade twelve. Students are selected by CES using a lottery system and welcomed into schools throughout Fairfield, with most remaining in Fairfield through graduation. Many FPS students participate in Magnet and Vocational Programs offered by surrounding towns. Each year, approximately 16 of our students attend the Six to Six Magnet School sponsored by CES, approximately 14 students attend Discovery Inter-district Magnet School sponsored by Bridgeport, approximately 20 students attend Bridgeport's Fairchild Wheeler Interdistrict Magnet High School, and over 100 students attend Bridgeport's Aquaculture Program. We have a small number of students who attend the Agriscience School, another small group at the Regional Center for the Arts in Trumbull, and a third small group who participate in the Global Studies Program in Norwalk. In addition to these choice programs, some of our schools participate in the One Book, Two Schools Program, which involves the entire school community and a sister school community in Bridgeport. Generally, the chosen reading provides opportunities to discuss a social topic across both communities and helps to support literacy.

In addition, Fairfield has two Preschool Programs to help reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation within the district. These programs are offered at two of our highest performing elementary schools and include programs for three and four year old students. Families who struggle economically may qualify for free or reduced tuition and free transportation and may attend from any of our elementary schools. Once the preschool program is completed, the child may be permanently enrolled in the "out of home district" elementary school and siblings may also attend.

Schools offer programs to highlight and celebrate diversity within the school and community, as well as beyond the town's borders. Fairfield Public Schools actively looks to increase our students' understanding of the world and their role within the global community. Reducing racial, social, and economic isolation will be a continual focus of district work going forward.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Fairfield School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

All of our schools receive funds for student supplies and activities based on a per student allocation. The allocation is based on an approximation of the cost of the program per student by level, and the school receives funding based on the enrollment times the allocation. Textbooks are purchased as part of the district budget on a six year revolving schedule to support new curricula. The cost of textbooks is based on the number of students with the assumption that each student needs at least one copy of the text and those costs are built into the district budget based on the Curriculum Revision Cycle. Technology is provided to students based on a Classroom Distribution Model, in which the necessary technology for every classroom at a given level (elementary, middle, high) is identified and supported in multi-year plans at the district level. Maintenance of technology equipment is also funded by the district on a five-year replacement plan. Facilities maintenance is also funded at the district level with a long term capital improvement plan to ensure all of our schools are built to capacity and in excellent condition.